



DNESC 4211 Programming For Analytics

Spring 2026

Overview

The Austin Animal Shelter has collected data on animal intakes and outcomes, but does not have the expertise to make sense of it. They have decided they want to take a data-driven approach to their business, and thus need your help. You will need to learn about their business and mission and then figure out how you can use their data to help them. There is some information below, but feel free to visit their site to find additional information about their business!

Suggested guide for the Exercise

- 1) Get acclimated with the three datasets (estimated time: Day 1 - 4:45-5:00)
- 2) Complete any necessary cleaning of the dataset (estimated time Day 1 - 5:00-5:15)
- 3) Explore and try to find insights to help the Animal Shelter (estimated time Day 1 – 5:15-6:00; Day 2 – 4:45-5:15)
 - a) Some example questions can be found below
 - 1) How can the data inform how the Austin Animal Shelter is achieving/not achieving their mission?
 - 2) What animals are most at-risk of adoption failure?
 - 3) What opportunities exist to improve adoption rates for certain animals?
- 4) Create Business Deliverable – (estimated time Day 2 - 5:15-5:50)
 - a) One person should submit their deliverable and code to the ASSN_04 slot
- 5) Class Wrap-up and Reflections (estimated time Day 2 - 5:50-6:00)

Teams

See Groups textfile